USER GUIDE

CGAP LENS: User Guide

Financial Regulatory Indicators with a Sociodemographic Lens

CGAP LENS: https://www.cgap.org/lens

Welcome to CGAP LENS

CGAP LENS is a free, interactive tool that helps financial sector authorities (FSAs) and other market actors make the most of disaggregated regulatory data. As a companion to CGAP's Technical Guide for Financial Sector Authorities on Using Disaggregated Regulatory Data to Support Financial Policy and Supervision (CGAP 2026), it offers a curated catalog of 230+ indicators spanning five policy mandates and six financial service areas — from financial inclusion and consumer protection to stability, sustainability, and market development. The tool is most useful when applied to specific policy questions, allowing users to explore the intersection of mandates and financial services. The indicators are not a global consensus; all definitions, classifications, and disaggregation options are working references that each user should adapt to their country context and institutional goals.

The catalog is built around high-level indicators that analysts can tailor through multiple layers of disaggregation — sociodemographic breakdowns such as gender, age, income, and location, as well as breakdowns by product type and financial service provider. Each indicator card includes definitions, data requirements and limitations, suggested breakdowns, and exploratory questions to guide interpretation and inform decisions on which indicators to request from FSPs and which to share with the broader market. A key feature is the ability to build, annotate, and export custom indicator sets tailored to specific priorities and data capacity. Where relevant, the tool also maps relationships to indicators from global initiatives including AFI, G20-GPFI, IMF FAS, and WE Finance Code, making CGAP LENS a practical starting point for designing or refining a more evidence-based and inclusive data architecture.

Contact

For inquiries please send an e-mail to: cgap@worldbank.org.

Getting Started: The Basics

COMPONENTS OF THE INTERFACE

CGAP LENS has three main components:

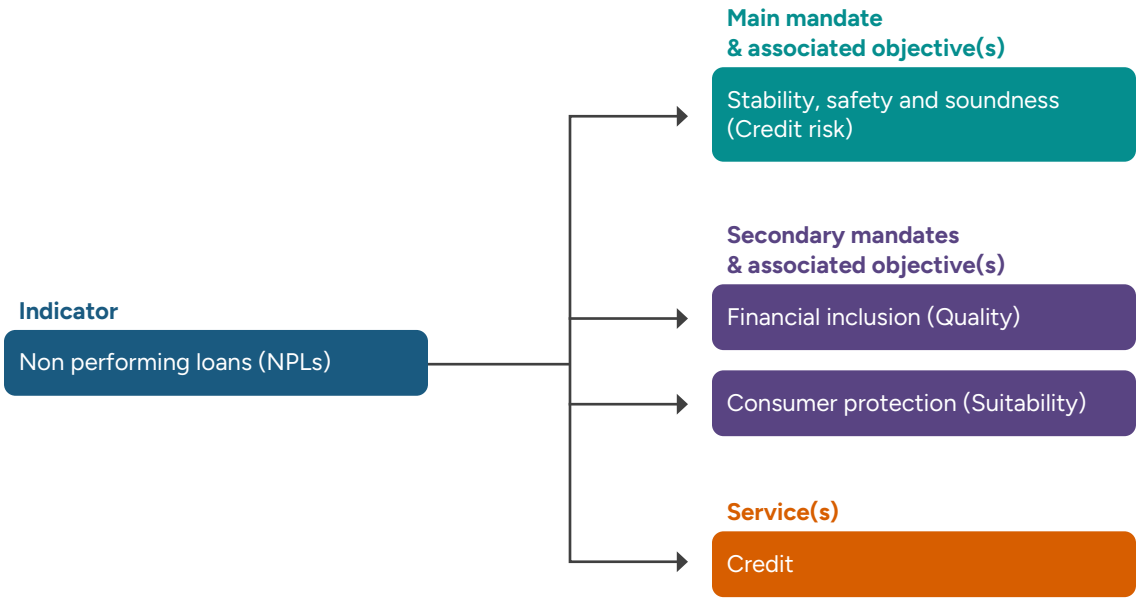
1. **Filter Panel (Left Sidebar)**: Narrow down indicators using multiple criteria. The sidebar includes an introductory description.
2. **BROWSE Tab (Top Right)**: Explore the complete catalog of indicators organized by mandate
3. **YOUR INDICATOR SET Tab (Top Right)**: View and manage your indicator sets

HOW THE INTERFACE IS ORGANIZED

Indicators are organized hierarchically:

- **Mandates**: Primary regulatory areas (e.g., Financial inclusion, Consumer protection, Stability, safety and soundness, Market development, Sustainability)
- **Objectives**: Specific objectives within each mandate (e.g., Access, Usage, Fair treatment, Suitability, Credit risk)
- **Services**: Financial service areas (e.g., Payments, Credit, Savings, Insurance, Investment, Pensions)

CGAP LENS is built on a database of indicators. Each indicator is mapped to a primary mandate and objective(s) that are most strongly aligned with it, as well as secondary mandates and objective(s) that the indicator can inform. Indicators can also be mapped to one or more financial services. In cases where multiple financial services are listed, no hierarchy is intended. The order is arbitrary.



Understanding how LENS supports segmented analysis

LENS is built around indicators — conceptual measures such as "Loans (number)" — rather than pre-built, fully specified metrics. The specificity required for segmented analysis is achieved by combining an indicator with one or more of the breakdowns suggested in each indicator card, which are dimensions of disaggregation such as customer type, customer gender, provider type, or product characteristics. For example, "Loans (number)" combined with the breakdowns "Customer type: legal person-MSME" and "customer gender: female" would produce the metric "Number of loans to women-owned MSMEs." This means that gender, MSME, and other analytical dimensions are embedded in the breakdowns rather than in indicator names. We recommend exploring the breakdown options within each indicator card to unlock the full analytical scope of the tool. The options listed under each breakdown represent the dimensions we consider most prevalent and analytically useful as a starting point, not a definitive or prescriptive list. Similarly, indicator definitions are proposed as reasonable reference points rather than fixed standards. Analysts are encouraged to adapt both indicators and breakdowns to their specific country or financial system context, selecting and combining the options that best reflect the data available to them and the questions they are trying to answer.

LENS covers retail financial services — that is, financial products and services provided to individuals and enterprises (micro, small, and medium). Unless otherwise specified, all indicators refer to this retail scope and do not capture wholesale or corporate financial activity. In contexts where the classification of MSME credit differs across institutions — for example, where some banks treat MSME lending as part of the corporate rather than the retail portfolio — analysts should note this limitation and interpret results accordingly.

Worked example — finding indicators for women-owned MSME credit. To see how indicators, breakdowns, and metrics work together, take the example of finding data on credit use by women-owned MSMEs. Start by filtering for "Financial Inclusion", "Uptake, Usage" and "Credit" in the left-hand panel — this returns indicators covering areas like borrowers, loans, and outstanding balances. Applying breakdowns for customer type (MSME) and gender (female) narrows these down to women-MSME-specific metrics. Additional breakdowns, such as FSP type or loan characteristics, allow for even more granular results — for example, "Number of micro digital loans made by Fintech providers to women-owned MSMEs".

For reference, the key terms are defined as follows:

- **Indicator:** a conceptual measure defined to track a phenomenon (e.g., "Loans, number").
- **Breakdown:** a dimension along which an indicator can be disaggregated (e.g., customer gender, customer type, FSP type). Breakdowns guide the analytical choices available to users within each indicator.
- **Metric:** a specific, operationalized expression of a disaggregated indicator, produced by applying one or more breakdowns (e.g., "Loans, number —women-owned MSMEs, MFIs"). Metrics are what analysts ultimately monitor.
- **Variable:** data describing a field or attribute in an underlying dataset (e.g., "number of loans," "gender," "FSP type"). Variables are the building blocks used to construct indicators and apply breakdowns, and belong in technical or data documentation rather than in the main user interface.

How to Use CGAP LENS

1. EXPLORING INDICATORS

Dynamic Header: As you apply filters, the BROWSE tab header (shown below) updates to display:

- Total number of indicators matching your criteria (e.g., "147 of 238 indicators")
- Number of mandates, objectives, and services/sectors represented
- Active filter showing what filters are currently applied

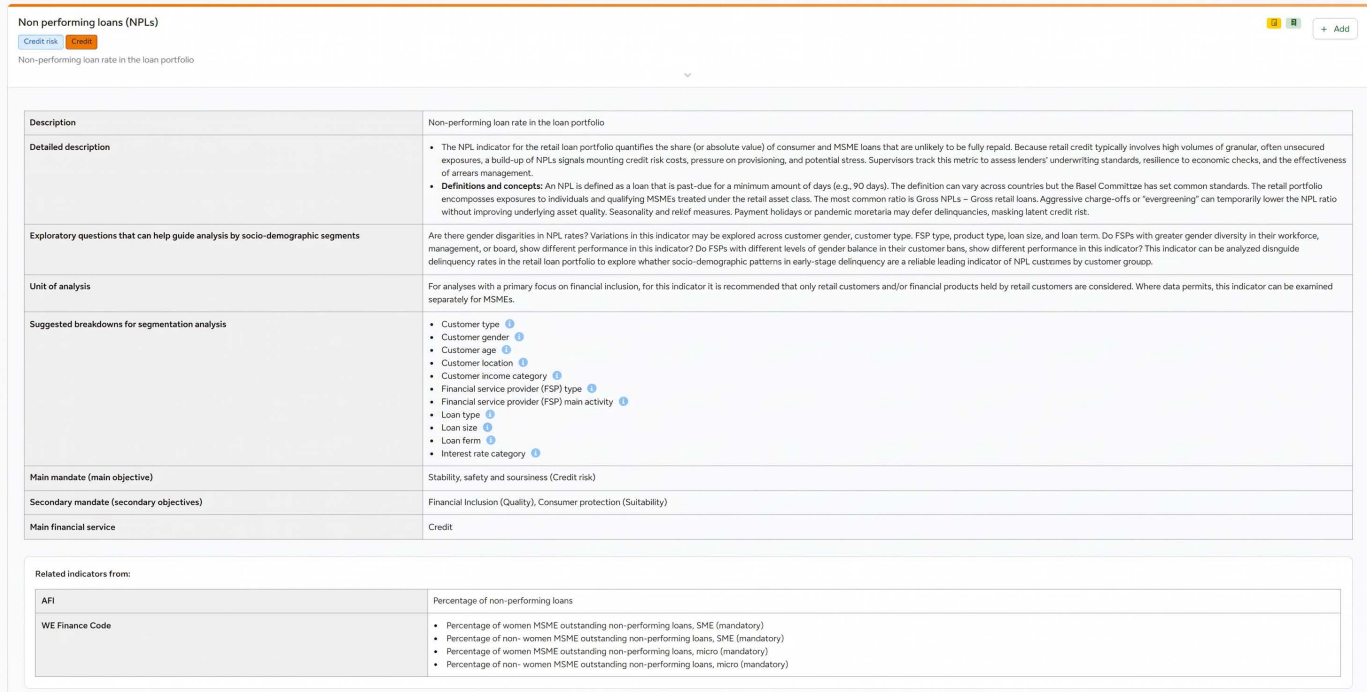


Start broadly: When you first open the app, you'll see all 230+ indicators organized by their primary mandate (as shown in the visual above). Use the **"Quick navigation"** panel on the right side of the screen to jump directly to a specific mandate section.

Expand for details: Click anywhere on an indicator card (white cards below the purple panel) to reveal:

- Detailed descriptions including explanations of key concepts and definitions, data requirements, and limitations
- Exploratory questions for sociodemographic analysis
- Unit of analysis information
- Main mandates and objectives (secondary as well, when relevant)
- Main service/sector (secondary as well, when relevant)
- Suggested data breakdowns
- Related indicators from international frameworks (IMF-FAS, GPFI, AFI, WE Finance Code, A2ii FeMa-Meter)

Indicator card example



Non performing loans (NPLs)

Credit risk | Credit

Non-performing loan rate in the loan portfolio

+ Add

Description	Non-performing loan rate in the loan portfolio
Detailed description	• The NPL indicator for the retail loan portfolio quantifies the share (or absolute value) of consumer and MSME loans that are unlikely to be fully repaid. Because retail credit typically involves high volumes of granular, often unsecured exposures, a build-up of NPLs signals mounting credit risk costs, pressure on provisioning, and potential stress. Supervisors track this metric to assess lenders' underwriting standards, resilience to economic checks, and the effectiveness of arrears management. • **Definitions and concepts:** An NPL is defined as a loan that is past-due for a minimum amount of days (e.g., 90 days). The definition can vary across countries but the Basel Committee has set common standards. The retail portfolio encompasses exposures to individuals and qualifying MSMEs treated under the retail asset class. The most common ratio is Gross NPLs – Gross retail loans. Aggressive charge-offs or "evergreening" can temporarily lower the NPL ratio without improving underlying asset quality. Seasonality and relief measures. Payment holidays or pandemic moretaria may defer delinquancies, masking latent credit rist.
Exploratory questions that can help guide analysis by socio-demographic segments	Are there gender disgarities in NPL rates? Variations in this indicator may be explored across customer gender, customer type. FSP type, product type, loan size, and loan term. Do FSPs with greater gender diversity in their workforce, management, or board, show different performance in this indicator? Do FSPs with different levels of gender balance in their customer bans, show different performance in this indicator? This indicator can be analyzed disnguide delinquency rates in the retail loan portfolio to explore whather socio-demographic patterns in early-stage delinquency are a reliable leading indicator of NPL custɔmes by customer grouɒ.
Unit of analysis	For analyses with a primary focus on financial inclusion, for this indicator it is recommended that only retail customers and/or financial products held by retail customers are considered. Where data permits, this indicator can be examined separately for MSMEs.
Suggested breakdowns for segmentation analysis	• Customer type • Customer gender • Customer age • Customer location • Customer income category • Financial service provider (FSP) type • Financial service provider (FSP) main activity • Loan type • Loan size • Loan ferm • Interest rate category
Main mandate (main objective)	Stability, safety and soursiness (Credit risk)
Secondary mandate (secondary objectives)	Financial Inclusion (Quality), Consumer protection (Suitability)
Main financial service	Credit

Related indicators from:

AFI	Percentage of non-performing loans
WE Finance Code	• Percentage of women MSME outstanding non-performing loans, SME (mandatory) • Percentage of non- women MSME outstanding non-performing loans, SME (mandatory) • Percentage of women MSME outstanding non-performing loans, micro (mandatory) • Percentage of non- women MSME outstanding non-performing loans, micro (mandatory)

2. FILTERING YOUR SEARCH

Search Box (Left Sidebar): Type keywords to find indicators with matching text. The search is case-insensitive and searches across multiple fields including indicator names, descriptions, mandates, objectives, and sectors.

Mandates Filter:

- Select one or more main regulatory mandate(s)
- Toggle "Include secondary mandates" ON to narrow your search

Objectives Filter:

- Choose specific main objectives within mandates
- Hierarchically organized for easy navigation
- Toggle "Include secondary objectives" OFF to show only the indicators strongly aligned

Services Filter:

- Filter by main financial service sector
- Toggle "Include cross-cutting indicators" OFF to filter for indicators that are exclusively relevant to the selected financial services. This will exclude indicators that also apply to other services.

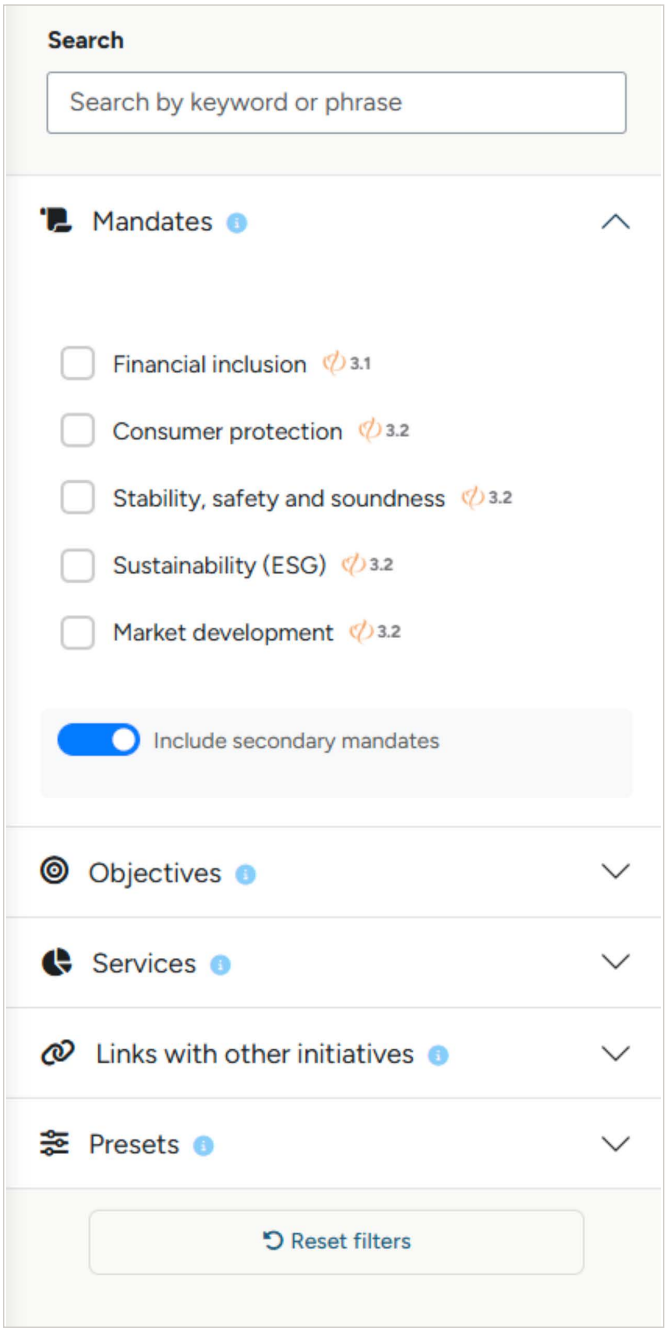
Links with other initiatives Filter:

- Select indicators that correspond with other indicators from select global initiatives, including the International Monetary Fund's Financial Access Survey (IMF-FAS), the Alliance for Financial Inclusion (AFI), Global Partnership for Financial Inclusion (GPFI), the World Bank Group's Women Entrepreneurs Finance (WE Finance) Code, and the Access to Insurance Initiative (A2ii) FeMa-Meter.

Presets Filter:

- Select indicators that align with cross-cutting themes, including digital finance ecosystem, MSME focus, financial health, gender diversity, and fraud monitoring.

Search and filter panel



3. BUILDING YOUR CUSTOM SET(S)

CGAP LENS lets you curate personalized indicator collections tailored to your needs. Whether you're preparing for a policy review, conducting research, or organizing indicators by project, the **Set Manager** makes it easy to organize, manage, and export your selections.

3.1 Understanding Indicator Sets:

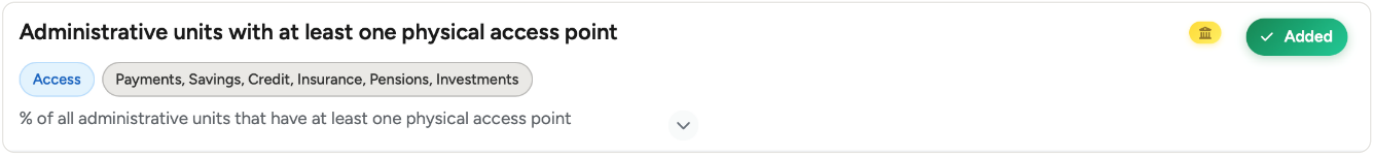
An **indicator set** is a named collection of indicators that you've selected from the catalog. Think of sets as folders where you can group related indicators together. For example, you might create:

- A "Q1 Financial Inclusion Review" set for quarterly reporting
- A "Gender Analysis Project" set for a specific research initiative
- A "Consumer Protection Indicators" set organized by regulatory mandate
- A "We-Fi indicators" set to inform indicator development and use

When you first visit the app, a default set called **"My Indicators"** is automatically created for you. You can find this in "YOUR INDICATOR SET" in the top right corner.

3.2 Adding Indicators to Your Set

1. Navigate to the **BROWSE** tab
2. Use the filters in the left sidebar to find indicators of interest
3. Click the **Add** button on any indicator card
4. The button changes to **Added** (green) to confirm the indicator is now in your active set



5. The badge on the "YOUR INDICATOR SET" tab updates to show your total count



Tip: You can add indicators to your set at any time while browsing. Your selections are preserved as you navigate and filter.

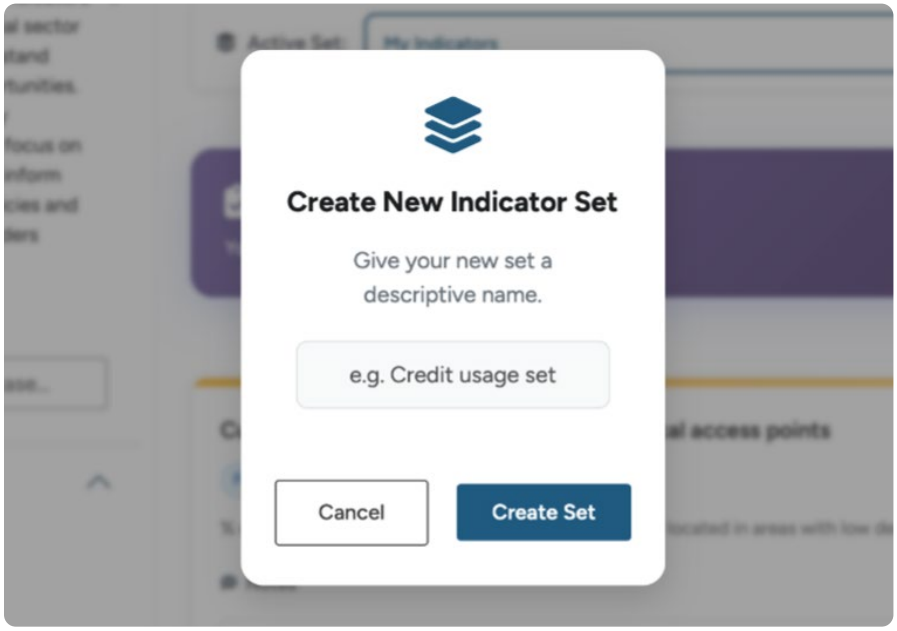
3.3 Managing Multiple Sets

The Set Manager (as shown below), located at the top of the **YOUR INDICATOR SET** tab, provides tools to organize your work across multiple indicator collections.



Creating a New Set

1. Click the **+ New Set** button (in green) in the Set Manager header
2. Enter a descriptive name for your set (e.g., "Consumer Protection Indicators")
3. Click **Create**
4. Your new set becomes the active set, ready for you to add indicators



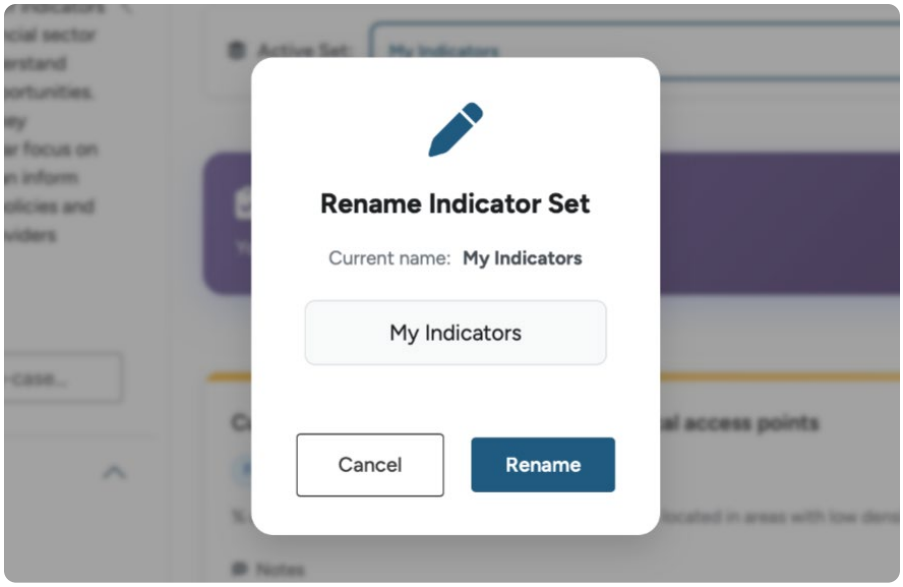
Switching Between Sets

Use the dropdown menu in the Set Manager to switch between your saved sets. When you switch:

- The indicator cards below update to show only indicators in the selected set
- Any indicators you add from the Browse page will go to the currently active set
- Your previous sets remain intact with all their indicators preserved

Renaming a Set

1. Select the set you want to rename from the dropdown
2. Click the **Rename** button (pencil icon)
3. Enter the new name
4. Click **Save**



Deleting a Set

1. Select the set you want to delete from the dropdown
2. Click the **Delete** button (trash icon)
3. Confirm the deletion when prompted

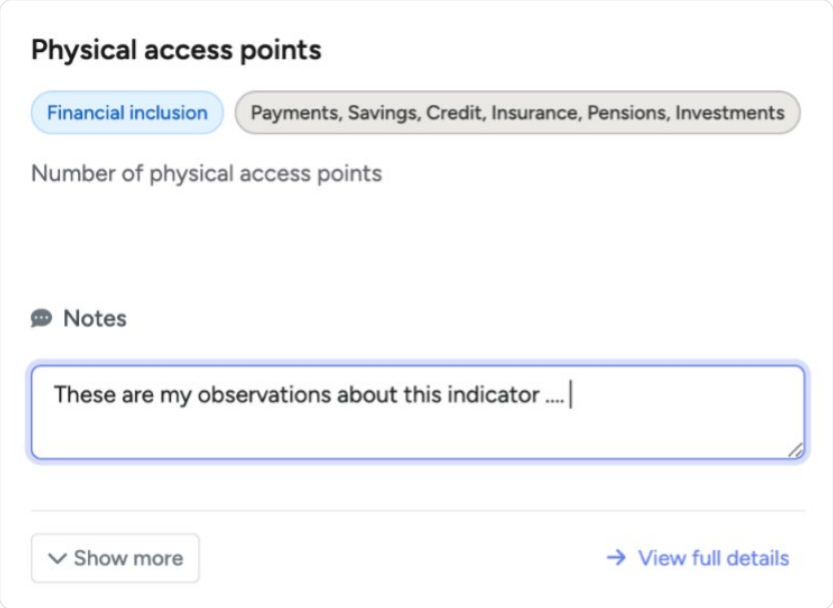
Note: Deleting a set removes all indicators from that collection. This action is irreversible.

3.4 Adding Notes to Indicators

Each indicator in your set includes a **Notes & Observations** text field where you can:

- Record why you selected this indicator
- Note specific considerations for your context
- Add reminders for follow-up analysis
- Document data availability or quality issues

These notes will be included when you export your set as a CSV or generate a PDF report.



3.5 Viewing Indicator Details

While in the YOUR INDICATOR SET tab, you can:

- Click **Show more** on any card to expand and view additional details including the detailed description and gender analysis questions
- Click **Show less** to collapse the expanded view
- Click **View full details** to navigate back to the Browse page for complete indicator information

3.6 Bulk Operations

For efficient set management, CGAP LENS provides bulk operations:

- **Add All**: When viewing filtered results in the Browse tab, add all displayed indicators to your active set at once
- **Remove All**: Clear all indicators from your current set



3.7 Exporting Your Set



Once you've built your custom set, you can export it in two formats:

CSV Export

Click the **CSV** button to download a spreadsheet containing:

- Indicator names and descriptions
- Mandate and objective classifications
- Sector assignments
- Your notes and observations

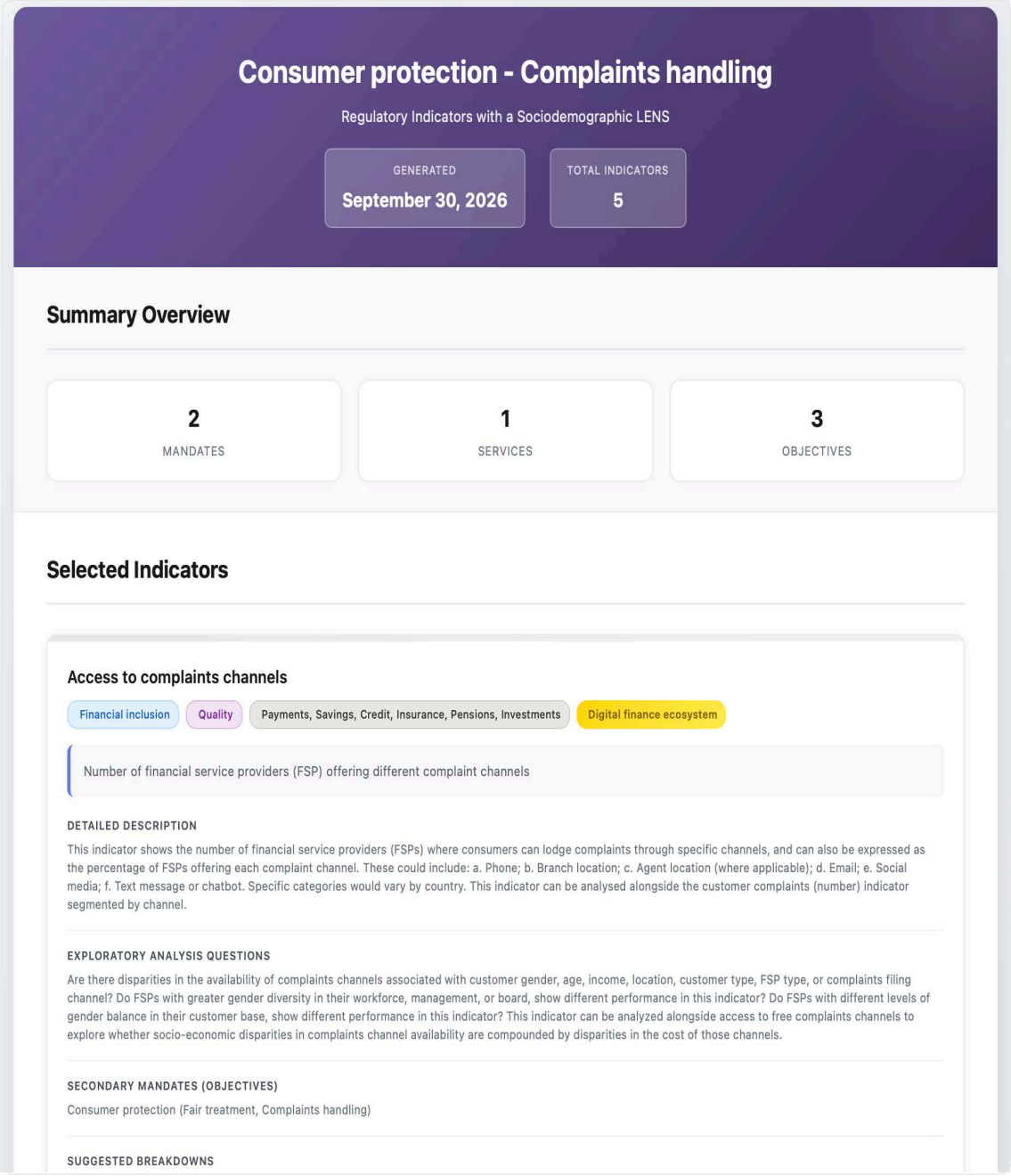
The filename automatically includes your set name and the current date (e.g., Q1_Review_2025-01-15.csv).

PDF Report

Click **Print Report** to generate a professionally formatted PDF document featuring:

- Your set name as the report title
- A summary overview with statistics
- Detailed indicator cards with full descriptions
- Your notes and observations
- CGAP LENS branding

The report opens in a new browser tab, which you can print or save.



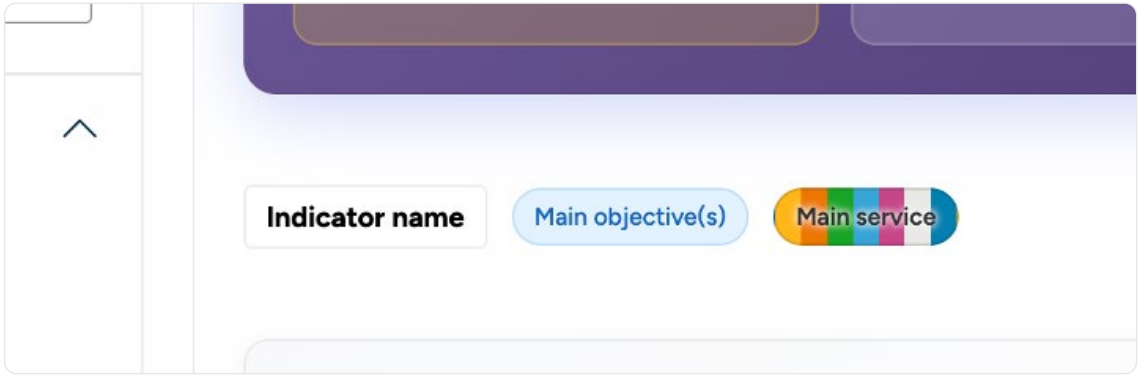
Tips for Effective Use

UNDERSTAND THE VISUAL KEY

Below the dynamic header, you'll see three example badges (see below) showing:

- **Indicator name** (white background)
- **Main objective(s)** (light blue background)
- **Main service** (rainbow gradient background)

This key helps you quickly understand what each badge represents while browsing indicators.



START BROAD, THEN NARROW

Begin with mandate-level filtering, then progressively add more specific criteria (objectives and/or services/sectors). This ensures you don't miss relevant indicators.

USE THE TOGGLE SWITCHES

The "Include secondary" toggles (in the Left Sidebar) are powerful for:

- **Comprehensive analysis**: Leave them ON to see all indicators that touch your topic
- **Focused analysis**: Turn them OFF if you want to see only primary classifications

LEVERAGE PRESETS

Different presets provide curated starting points based on common use cases.

REVIEW RELATED INDICATORS

When you expand an indicator card, check the "Related indicators from" section to see how your selection aligns with other international frameworks and initiatives.

Understanding Indicator Details

DOWNLOADING THE FULL CATALOG

At the top of the BROWSE tab, you'll see a **"Download full catalog"** link that allows you to download the complete Excel file containing all indicators with their full metadata as well as the full catalog of breakdowns considered, in a separate tab. This is useful for:

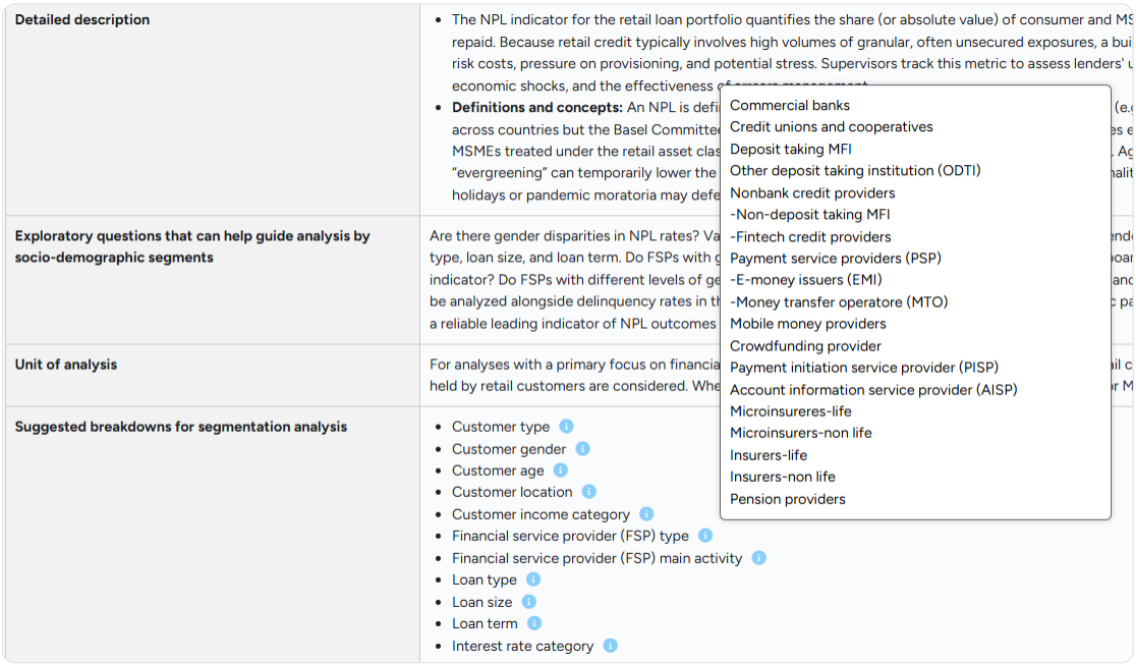
- Offline analysis and review
- Sharing with colleagues who may not have access to the web application
- Creating custom reports or analyses in Excel

DATA BREAKDOWNS

Each indicator includes suggested breakdowns for sociodemographic analysis, such as:

- **Customer characteristics**: Gender, age, income, location
- **Provider characteristics**: FSP type, FSP gender diversity
- **Product characteristics**: Type, size, term, channel
- **Transaction characteristics**: Type, value, frequency

These breakdowns allow you to examine differences across population segments. To view the available options for each breakdown, click the information icon. For example, for the indicator **"Rejections of product applications,"** an example of an intersectional view combining the breakdowns suggested would be: "**Rejections of (product type) by (type of FSP) for (type of customer)"**, for instance: *Rejections of mortgage loans by commercial banks to rural female individuals under 30 years old.*



Troubleshooting

COMMON ISSUES

No indicators appear after filtering:

- Click "Reset filters" at the bottom of the filter panel
- Check if you've applied contradictory filters (e.g., selecting only one mandate but objectives from different mandates)
- Try broadening your search by using fewer filters

Print Report not generating:

- Ensure pop-ups are allowed for the website
- Check your browser's pop-up blocker settings
- The report opens in a new tab/window

CSV download contains no data:

- Verify you have selected indicators in YOUR INDICATOR SET tab
- Check your browser's download settings
- Try downloading again after refreshing the page

Getting Help

CGAP LENS is a companion resource to CGAP's **Technical Guide** for Financial Sector Authorities on Using Disaggregated Regulatory Data to Support Financial Policy and Supervision.

In-App Resources

- **Tooltip icons**: Hover over these throughout the app for quick explanations
- **About button**: To obtain more information about CGAP LENS and access the LENS Video Tutorial, this User Guide, and CGAP's Technical Guide Using Disaggregated Regulatory Data to Support Financial Policy and Supervision.

Technical Notes

- **Indicator Count**: The catalog contains 238 indicators
- **Coverage**: Indicators span 5 mandates, 30 specific objectives, and six services/sectors
- **Application URL**: https://www.cgap.org/lens
- **Browser Compatibility**: Works best in modern browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge). Ensure JavaScript is enabled.
- **Data Privacy**: Your indicator selections are stored only in your browser session and are not transmitted to any server.

Quick Reference Card

Task	Action
Find all financial inclusion indicators	Select "Financial inclusion" under Mandates filter
Refine selection by one specific Objective	Select "Usage" under Objectives filter
Refine selection by one specific financial sector activity	Select "Credit" under Services filter
Search for specific terms	Use the search box at the top of the filter panel
See link to global initiatives	Toggle selected preset ON
View detailed information	Click anywhere on an indicator card to expand
Add to your custom set	Click the "Add" button on the indicator card
Review your selections	Navigate to "Your Indicator Set" tab
Export for analysis	Click "CSV" button in Your Indicator Set
Create a report	Click "Print Report" button in Your Indicator Set
Jump to a specific mandate	Use Quick Navigation panel on the right
Clear all filters	Click "Reset filters" button at bottom of filter panel

CGAP LENS is developed by CGAP, a global partnership of more than 40 leading development organizations that works to advance the lives of people living in poverty, especially women, through financial inclusion.

CGAP Members

AFD

AGENZIA ITALIANA PER LA COOPERAZIONE ALLO SVILUPPO

AGRA Sustainably Growing Africa's Food Systems

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European Investment Bank

EXPERTISE FRANCE
GROUPE AFD

Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development

FMO
Entrepreneurial Development Bank

Gates Foundation

giz

Global Affairs Canada

IAIS International Association of Insurance Supervisors

IDB LAB

IFC International Finance Corporation

IMPACT FUND DENMARK

IFAD
Investing in rural people

International Labour Organization

JOA
JERSEY OVERSEAS AID

KFW

KOICA Korea International Cooperation Agency

THE GOVERNMENT OF THE GRAND DUCHY OF LUXEMBOURG

LUXDEV
Luxembourg Development Agency

CGAP members and strategic partners as of September 2026

CGAP Members (continued)

center for inclusive growth

mastercard foundation

MetLife Foundation

Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation

Ministère de l'Économie, des Finances et de la Souveraineté industrielle et numérique — Direction générale du Trésor

Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Netherlands

Norad

PROPARCO Groupe AFD

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Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation SDC

Schweizerische Eidgenossenschaft
Confédération suisse
Confederazione Svizzera
Confederaziun svizra

Swiss Confederation

Federal Department of Economic Affairs, Education and Research EAER
State Secretariat for Economic Affairs SECO

Sida

Swedfund

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WFP
World Food Programme

UKaid
from the British people

UNCDF
Microfinance • Capital Development

UNDP

CGAP Strategic Partners

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CGAP members and strategic partners as of September 2026



Transforming Lives with Financial Inclusion

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